Roasted pumpkin pie filling

A brown sugar custard for one deep pie, made with your own roasted pumpkin

Serves 8–10 · **Makes** one 23 cm (9 in) deep-dish pie · **Prep** 15 min · **Cook** 1 h · **Rest** 3 h · Adapted from cucinabyelena.com

Roasting the pumpkin yourself caramelises its sugars for a deeper flavour than canned purée. Fresh purée is wetter than canned, so drain it if it looks loose, and take the pie out while the centre still jiggles.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 large eggs, at room temperature
- 165 g (¾ cup) packed brown sugar
- 450 g (2 cups) roasted pumpkin purée, drained if watery
- 1 tbsp pumpkin pie spice, or 1 tsp cinnamon, ½ tsp ginger, ¼ tsp nutmeg and ¼ tsp cloves
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ¼ tsp kosher salt
- 1 tbsp plain flour (optional; it helps set the wetter fresh purée)
- 250 ml (1 cup) heavy cream, or half-and-half for a lighter custard
- 1 unbaked or blind-baked 23 cm (9 in) deep-dish pie shell

METHOD

1. **Heat the oven.** Heat the oven to 200 °C (400 °F).
2. **Whisk the base.** Whisk the eggs and brown sugar in a large bowl until smooth and slightly pale.
3. **Add the purée.** Whisk in the pumpkin purée, spice, vanilla, salt and the flour, if using, until evenly mixed.
4. **Add the cream.** Pour in the cream slowly, whisking gently, until you have a smooth, pourable custard.
5. **Bake hot.** Pour the custard into the pie shell and bake for 15 minutes to set the edges of the crust.
6. **Finish lower.** Without opening the door, turn the oven down to 175 °C (350 °F) and bake for another 40–45 minutes, until the edges are set and only the very centre still jiggles.
7. **Cool.** Cool on a rack at room temperature for 2–3 hours, as the custard finishes setting while it cools. Refrigerate until serving.

NOTES

- Roasting the pumpkin. Halve a sugar pumpkin, scoop out the seeds and roast it cut side down on a lined tray at 200 °C (400 °F) for 45–60 minutes, until a knife slides in easily. Scoop out the flesh.
- Drain it. If the purée looks loose, drain it in a sieve lined with cheesecloth or a clean tea towel for 30 minutes before measuring.
- Make it smooth. Blend the roasted flesh in a food processor or blender for a full minute, to get the silky texture of canned purée.